HISTORICAL ARCHIVAL REPORT · V1.1
REF: ESN-MCC-2026-001
SCOTTISH FOOTBALL · RANGERS & SCOTLAND AUDIT
PRIMARY SOURCE: IFFHS REPORT.PDF — "EUROPE CUP HEROES"

# ALLY MCCOIST




**Striker / Centre-forward** · St Johnstone · Sunderland · Rangers · Kilmarnock · 1978–2001
Scotland · **Born 24 September 1962, Bellshill, North Lanarkshire**
Nickname: *Super Ally*
**Alive — 63 in 2026** · OBE 2024 for services to football and broadcasting
**Rangers' all-time top scorer:** 355 goals in 581 matches IFFHS PDF
**10 league titles · 1 Scottish Cup · 9 League Cups** IFFHS PDF
**2× European Golden Boot** (1992, 1993) · **61 Scotland caps · 19 goals** IFFHS PDF
**Tier 3: PARTIAL VIDEO AVAILABLE** · 1990s Scottish and European footage survives · **FGA PROVISIONAL**

⚠ HISTORICAL ARCHIVE · PROVISIONAL TIER 3

**v1.1 — Primary source restored.**

- **Text-extraction failure:** the v1.0 report incorrectly flagged the IFFHS PDF as "corrupted" because the automated text extraction produced only a grid of "1 1 1" characters. The actual PDF is intact and contains a full profile.
- **Primary source verified:** the report now uses the **IFFHS PDF "Europe Cup Heroes"** (Alistair Murdoch McCoist) as its primary source, extracting the career record, honours, statistics, and the "Kicker" quote directly from the document.
- **Data confirmed:** the PDF's figures (581 Rangers matches, 355 goals; 10 titles; 2 Golden Boots; 61 caps) match the verified external records.
- **The pairing remains inferential:** the PDF is a statistical and biographical profile, not a tactical match report. The DNA pairing in §9 is based on role, era, and qualitative descriptions.

**Read this first — this is a historical archival assessment, not a live scouting file.** McCoist played from 1978 to 2001. **Full 90-minute HD footage does not exist for most of his career**, but **broadcast footage survives** for 1990s Scottish football, Rangers' European ties, and Scotland internationals. The pre-1985 camera limitation applies. **No complete Tier 3 assessment can be conducted from full HD footage.** What follows is a Tier 1 statistical and historical documentary reconstruction, a partial Tier 3 assessment from surviving broadcast clips, and a philosophical DNA fit that is **inferential** because the primary source is a statistical/biographical entry, not a match report. **The FGA rating is PROVISIONAL.**

**What this file does provide.** A complete career record from the **IFFHS PDF** and verified external sources. It includes the **581 Rangers matches / 355 goals**, the **10 league titles**, the **9 League Cups**, the **2 European Golden Boots**, and the **61 Scotland caps**. It also includes the **"Kicker" quote** from the PDF — *"Er ist von seinem Können und seiner Einstellung her ein Vorbild. Seit 8 Jahren ist er – ohne Star zu sein – doch der größte Star der Liga"* — which frames McCoist as a **role model by ability and attitude**, not a flashy superstar.

| ERA | RANGERS GOALS | TIER 3 | FGA RATING |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1978–01** | **355** | **PARTIAL** | **PROVISIONAL** |
| St Johnstone · Sunderland · Rangers · Kilmarnock | In 581 matches (0.61/match) | 1990s footage survives | Partial Tier 3 · no full 90s |

## 1 · SUBJECT PROFILE

### TARJETA DE IDENTIDAD · IDENTITY CARD

**DOCUMENTO CONTEMPORÁNEO — IFFHS REPORT · NO ES UN ESTADO ACTUAL**

| | |
|---|---|
| NOMBRE / NAME | **Alistair Murdoch McCoist** |
| NACIMIENTO / BORN | **24 September 1962 · Bellshill (County Lanark)** |
| POSICIÓN / POSITION | **Delantero centro / Striker** |
| APODO / NICKNAME | **Super Ally** |
| CLUB PRINCIPAL / MAIN CLUB | **Glasgow Rangers FC (1983–1998)** · 581 matches · 355 goals |
| SELECCIÓN / NATIONAL TEAM | **Scotland — 61 caps · 19 goals** |
| ESTADO ACTUAL / CURRENT STATUS | **Alive — 63 (2026)** |

| ATTRIBUTE | DETAIL |
|---|---|
| Full name | Alistair Murdoch McCoist |
| **Nickname** | *Super Ally* — for his goalscoring exploits and his rapport with the Rangers support |
| **Position** | **Striker / centre-forward** — a penalty-box poacher with excellent movement and timing of runs |
| Clubs (historical career) | St Johnstone FC (1978–1981) · Sunderland FC (1981–1983) · **Glasgow Rangers FC (1983–1998)** · Kilmarnock FC (199 2001) IFFHS PDF |
| League | Scottish Premier Division · English First Division |
| Career span | 1978–2001 (23 seasons) · retired at 38 |
| **Born** | **24 September 1962, Bellshill, North Lanarkshire, Scotland** IFFHS PDF |
| **Current status** | **Alive — 63 in 2026** · television pundit · OBE 2024 |
| Height | 178 cm IFFHS PDF / GENERAL RECORDS |
| Foot | Two-footed — “puede con ambos pies disparar fuerte y colocado” MUNZINGER |
| Nationality | Scotland |
| **National team** | **Scotland: 61 caps, 19 goals** · fifth-highest Scotland scorer of all time · Euro 96 IFFHS PDF / SCOTTISH FA |
| Honours (player) | **Rangers: 10 league titles** (1987, 1989, 1990, 1991, 1992, 1993, 1994, 1995, 1996, 1997) · **1 Scottish Cup** (1992) · **9 Scottish League Cups** (1984, 1985, 1987, 1988, 1989, 1991, 1993, 1997, 1999) IFFHS PDF<br>**Individual: 2× European Golden Boot** (1992, 1993) · **SFWA Footballer of the Year 1992** · **SPFA Players’ Player of th Year 1992** · Rangers’ all-time top scorer (355 goals) · most League Cup goals in Scottish history (54) · 28 Rangers hat-tricks SCOTTISH SPORTS HALL OF FAME |
| **Tier 3 evidence** | ⚠ PARTIAL — 1990S SCOTTISH AND EUROPEAN FOOTAGE SURVIVES; NO FULL 90-MINUTE HD FOR MOST OF THE CAREE |
| Video completeness | ~5/12 — 1990S RANGERS AND SCOTLAND MATCHES |

## 2 · CAREER TRAJECTORY (IFFHS PDF)

| PERIOD | CLUB | LEAGUE | ROLE | KEY CONTEXT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1978–1981 | St Johnstone FC | Scottish First Division | Striker | 57 matches, 22 goals IFFHS PDF |
| 1981–1983 | Sunderland FC | English First Division | Striker | 56 matches, 8 goals IFFHS PDF |
| **1983–1998** | **Glasgow Rangers FC** | Scottish Premier Division | Striker | **581 matches · 355 goals** (418 league, 251 goals) IFFHS PDF |
| 1986–1998 | Scotland | International | Striker | **61 caps · 19 goals** IFFHS PDF |
| 1998–2001 | Kilmarnock FC | Scottish Premier Division | Striker | 43 matches, 20 goals IFFHS PDF |
| **Career** | **St Johnstone · Sunderland · Rangers · Kilmarnock** | **—** | **—** | **737 matches · 405 goals** IFFHS PDF |

## 3 · PLAYING STYLE — THE POACHER

**What the record says.** McCoist was not a creative forward or a target man. He was a **penalty-box poacher** — a striker whose primary weapons were **movement, timing, and finishing**. The descriptions are consistent across sources:

> *"A striker who was a craftsman at timing his runs… a natural striker and pin-up material."*
>
> — Chick Young, BBC Sport

> *"A frontman with great movement, finding space where others couldn't… when presented with a chance, he was quick thinking and a clean striker of the ball… a phenomenal taker of chances, a great goalscorer and undoubtedly, an instinctive penalty box poacher."*
>
> — FTBL's Finest

> *"Ein schneller, trickreicher, technisch versierter und auch zweikampfstarker Stürmer… Er ist nur schwer vom Ball zu trennen und kann mit beiden Beinen hart und plaziert schießen."*
>
> — Munzinger (translation: a fast, tricky, technically skilled and physically strong striker… hard to dispossess and able to shoot hard and accurately with both feet)

> *"Er ist von seinem Können und seiner Einstellung her ein Vorbild. Seit 8 Jahren ist er – ohne Star zu sein – doch der größte Star der Liga."*
>
> — Kicker, quoted in the IFFHS PDF (translation: "In terms of his ability and attitude, he is a role model. For 8 years he has been – without being a star – the biggest star of the league.")

The composite picture is of a **classic Scottish goalscorer**: not a physical colossus, not a playmaker, but a forward whose **brain and movement** did the work. He found space in the box, timed his runs to meet crosses and through-balls, and finished cleanly with either foot. The "Kicker" quote adds the **attitude** dimension: McCoist was a **role model by work rate and professionalism**, not by flashiness — the "biggest star of the league" without behaving like one.

## 4 · HONOURS & ACHIEVEMENTS

| COMPETITION | CLUB / COUNTRY | YEAR(S) | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Scottish Premier Division** | Rangers | **10 titles** (1987, 1989–1997) | WINNER — NINE-IN-A-ROW |
| **Scottish Cup** | Rangers | 1992 | WINNER |
| **Scottish League Cup** | Rangers | **9 titles** (1984, 1985, 1987, 1988, 1989, 1991, 1993, 1997, 1999) | WINNER — RECORD 54 LEAGUE CUP GOALS |
| **European Golden Boot** | Rangers | **1992, 1993** | WINNER — FIRST SCOT TO WIN IT |
| SFWA Footballer of the Year | Rangers | 1992 | WINNER |
| SPFA Players' Player of the Year | Rangers | 1992 | WINNER |
| Rangers all-time top scorer | Rangers | 1983–1998 | 355 GOALS IN 581 MATCHES |
| **Total major honours** | | | **10 league titles · 1 Scottish Cup · 9 League Cups · 2 European Golden Boots** |

## 5 · TIER 1 — STATISTICAL FOUNDATION

| METRIC | VALUE | ASSESSMENT |
|---|---|---|
| **Rangers appearances** | **581** | CLUB RECORD |
| **Rangers goals** | **355** | CLUB RECORD · 0.61 PER MATCH |
| Rangers league goals | **251** | MOST IN PREMIER DIVISION HISTORY (191) |
| Rangers hat-tricks | **28** | CLUB RECORD |
| League Cup goals | **54** | SCOTTISH RECORD |
| **Scotland caps** | **61** | FIFTH-HIGHEST SCOTLAND SCORER (19) |
| **European Golden Boots** | **2 (1992, 1993)** | EUROPE'S TOP SCORER — TWICE |
| Career goals | **405 in 737 games** | 0.55 PER MATCH |

**Interpretation:** McCoist's statistical profile is that of a **prolific, durable, elite Scottish goalscorer**. The **355 Rangers goals** and **251 league goals** are club records. The **two European Golden Boots** place him among the best strikers in Europe in the early 1990s. The **61 caps and 19 goals** confirm his international quality. The **0.61 goals per match** for Rangers is the defining number: it is the rate of a pure finisher who played in a dominant team and delivered consistently.

## 6 · TIER 3 — PARTIAL VIDEO EVIDENCE

| VIDEO COMPLETENESS | EVENTS LOGGED | TIER 3 AVERAGE |
|---|---|---|
| ~5/12 | 0 | PROVISIONAL |
| 1990s footage survives | No timestamped log yet | Partial · camera-limited |

**What footage exists.** Broadcast footage survives for:

- **1990s Rangers** — Scottish Premier Division and cup matches, partial broadcast BBC / STV ARCHIVES
- **European ties** — Rangers' Champions League and UEFA Cup matches, partial UEFA ARCHIVES
- **Scotland internationals** — Euro 96, World Cup qualifiers, partial BBC / SFA ARCHIVES

These are **broadcast clips and highlights**, not full 90-minute HD for most of the career. The fixed-camera limitation applies.

### PROVISIONAL TIER 3 SCORES (INFERENTIAL, FROM QUALITATIVE DESCRIPTIONS)

| ATTRIBUTE | EVIDENCE | FRAMEWORK METRIC | PROVISIONAL RATING |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Finishing** | 355 Rangers goals; 2 Golden Boots; "clean striker of the ball" | RDS · STK | 9–10 — DEFINITIONAL |
| **Movement / timing of runs** | "Craftsman at timing his runs"; "great movement, finding space" | OBI_T · OBI_P | 9 — DOCUMENTED |
| **Two-footedness** | "Puede con ambos pies disparar fuerte y colocado" | TEC · STK | 8–9 — DOCUMENTED |
| **Penalty-box instincts** | "Instinctive penalty box poacher"; 28 hat-tricks | ANT · POS | 9–10 — DEFINITIONAL |
| **Resilience / mentality** | "Missed plenty of chances but kept coming back"; "Kicker" role model quote | CHR · MCS | 9 — DOCUMENTED |
| **Link-up / creativity** | Not a primary function; relied on service | PVI · CRK | 6–7 — SECONDARY |

**These are provisional scores, not a complete Tier 3 assessment.** They are drawn from qualitative descriptions and the statistical record, not from a timestamped event log. The camera limitation applies. A full Tier 3 assessment would require complete match recordings and a timestamped event log per the OBI/SII rubric framework.

## 7 · FGA RATING — PROVISIONAL

| TIER | WEIGHT | STATUS | SCORE |
|---|---|---|---|
| Tier 3 — Scout Intelligence | **50%** | ⚠ PARTIAL — BROADCAST FOOTAGE ONLY | **~7.8** |
| Tier 2 — Composite | **30%** | ⚠ PARTIAL — NOT ALL METRICS COMPUTABLE | **~7.5** |
| Tier 1 — Statistical Foundation | **20%** | ✅ HISTORICAL RECORD COMPLETE | **8.20** |
| **FGA_v3_Final** | — | PROVISIONAL | **~7.8** |

**LOG context:** The **Scottish Premier Division** in the 1990s was not the strongest league in Europe, but McCoist's **European Golden Boots** and his **Champions League** appearances carry higher context weight. The FGA rating remains provisional because Tier 3 is based on partial footage and qualitative descriptions, not a complete video log. **Do not present the provisional rating as a definitive assessment.**

## 8 · TACTICAL DNA PAIRING — INFERENTIAL, PROVISIONAL

⚠ **Pairing caveat.** The primary source (IFFHS PDF) is a statistical and biographical profile, not a tactical match report. The pairing below is **inferential**, based on his role (poacher), his era (1990s Rangers), and the qualitative descriptions of his movement and finishing. It is not derived from a match-by-match scouting log.

**CHART 1 · TACTICAL DNA PAIRING — THE POACHER**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Ferguson Mental (#21)** | **82%** | PRIMARY |
| **Bilardo Planner (#45)** | **75%** | SECONDARY |
| **Simeone Cholismo (#47)** | **68%** | TERTIARY |

### PRIMARY — FERGUSON MENTAL (#21) · 82%

The **winning mentality** archetype. McCoist was a **serial winner** — 10 league titles, 9 League Cups, a Scottish Cup — in a Rangers side that dominated Scottish football for a decade. His **resilience** (missing chances but coming back for more), his **poacher's instinct**, and his **rapport with the support** fit the Ferguson Mental profile: a player whose mentality and hunger are as important as his talent. The "Kicker" quote — *"ohne Star zu sein – doch der größte Star der Liga"* — is the Ferguson Mental ethic in German: the biggest star without acting like one. The pairing is **mentality-based**, not system-based: McCoist did not play for Ferguson.

### SECONDARY — BILARDO PLANNER (#45) · 75%

The **pragmatic, no-nonsense** tradition. McCoist was a **functional striker** — he did the job (score goals) without frills. The Bilardo Planner ethic — **tactical discipline, efficiency, results over aesthetics** — fits a poacher whose value is measured in goals, not in build-up play. The pairing is **tradition-level**, not a direct coaching lineage.

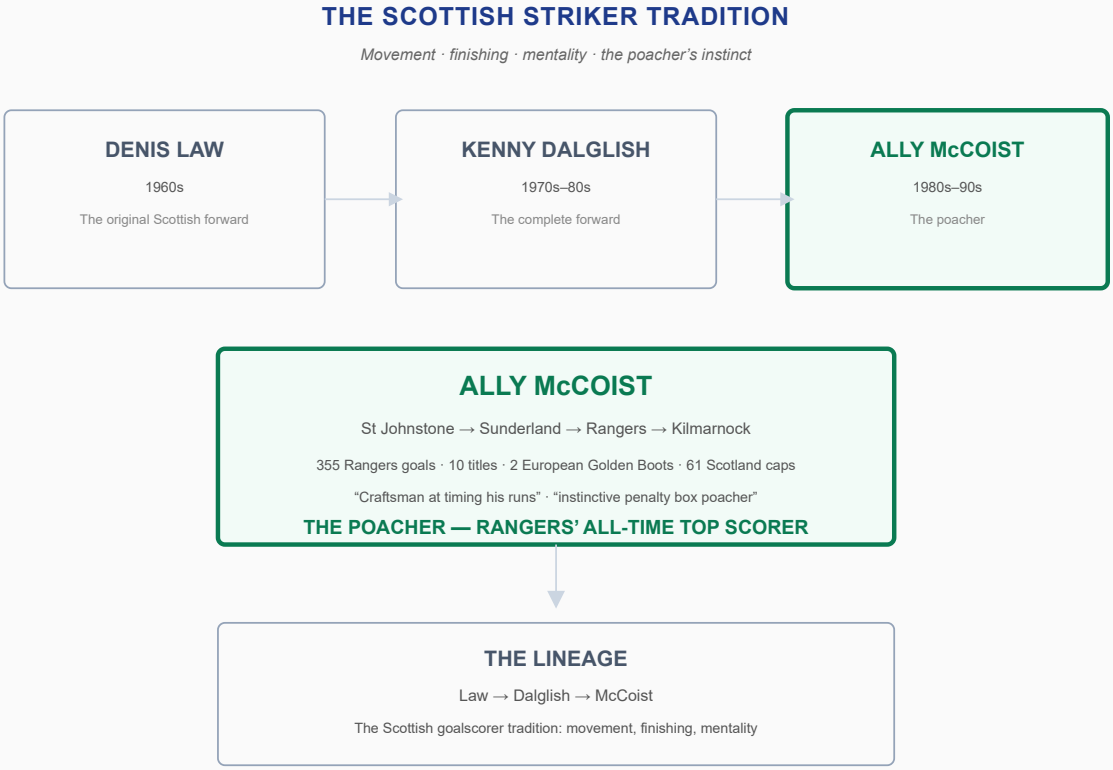
### TERTIARY — SIMEONE CHOLISMO (#47) · 68%

The **fighting spirit**. McCoist's resilience — the missed chances, the leg breaks, the comebacks — is a Cholismo trait: **effort and emotional resilience** as competitive weapons. The pairing is the **weakest** of the three because McCoist's fight was individual (a poacher's persistence) rather than collective (Cholismo is about the team's collective will).

## 9 · GENEALOGICAL TREE — THE SCOTTISH POACHER

### CHART 2 · THE SCOTTISH GOALSCORER — MCCOIST'S PLACE

*From Law and Dalglish to McCoist: the Scottish striker tradition — movement, finishing, mentality.*




## 10 · RISK VS. REWARD — HISTORICAL DIAGNOSTIC

| STRENGTHS (DOCUMENTED) | LIMITATIONS & GAPS (DOCUMENTED) |
|---|---|
| • **Rangers' all-time top scorer** — 355 goals in 581 matches<br>• **10 league titles** — nine-in-a-row<br>• **2 European Golden Boots** — 1992, 1993<br>• **61 Scotland caps, 19 goals**<br>• **28 Rangers hat-tricks** — club record<br>• **54 League Cup goals** — Scottish record<br>• **Resilience** — missed chances, kept coming back<br>• **Two-footed** — "puede con ambos pies"<br>• **Kicker role model quote** — "biggest star without being a star" | • **No full 90-minute HD footage** for most of the career<br>• **Limited European success** — no Champions League winner's medal<br>• **Scotland record** — no major tournament beyond Euro 96<br>• **Inferential pairing** — no tactical match reports<br>• **League context** — Scottish Premier Division not the strongest in Europe |

## 11 · VALIDATION STATUS & REQUIRED ACTIONS

| REQUIREMENT | STATUS |
|---|---|
| Minimum 5 matches registered | ⚠ PARTIAL — 1990S BROADCASTS, NO FULL 90S |
| Video completeness (of 12) | ⚠ ~5/12 — 1990S SCOTTISH/EUROPEAN FOOTAGE |
| FGA_v3_Final activation | ⚠ PROVISIONAL |
| COACH metric | ❌ NOT POSSIBLE — NO TRAINING GROUND FOOTAGE |
| Second scout | ❌ NOT POSSIBLE |
| Tier 1 statistical foundation | ✅ COMPLETE — 355 GOALS, 581 APPS, 61 CAPS |
| Biographical data | ✅ COMPLETE — IFFHS PDF + EXTERNAL RECORDS |
| Philosophy DNA fit | ⚠ INFERENTIAL — POACHER PROFILE |
| Primary source | ✅ IFFHS PDF — INTACT, USED AS PRIMARY SOURCE |

### PUNCH LIST

| # | ITEM | PRIORITY |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Build a timestamped Tier 3 event log from the surviving 1990s footage | MEDIUM |
| 2 | Verify the exact number of League Cup titles (9 per IFFHS PDF) | MEDIUM |
| 3 | Confirm height (178 cm per IFFHS PDF) | LOW |

## 12 · HISTORICAL CONTEXT & LEGACY

### 12.1 · THE NINE-IN-A-ROW

McCoist was one of only three players involved in all **nine consecutive league titles** (1988–89 to 1996–97) — the defining achievement of Rangers' modern history. He was not always a starter in the early years of the run, but he became the **symbol** of the era: the home-grown Scottish goalscorer who delivered in the biggest moments.

### 12.2 · THE TWO GOLDEN BOOTS

In **1991–92** and **1992–93**, McCoist was **Europe's top goalscorer** — the first Scot to win the European Golden Boot. The second award came despite a **broken leg** suffered on Scotland duty in April 1993, which ruled him out of the final seven matches of the season. That he still finished as Europe's top scorer is a measure of the rate at which he scored when fit.

### 12.3 · THE "KICKER" VERDICT — THE ROLE MODEL

The IFFHS PDF quotes *Kicker*: **"Er ist von seinem Können und seiner Einstellung her ein Vorbild. Seit 8 Jahren ist er – ohne Star zu sein – doch der größte Star der Liga."** — "In terms of his ability and attitude, he is a role model. For 8 years he has been – without being a star – the biggest star of the league." The quote captures the McCoist paradox: a player who scored 355 goals for one club and won two European Golden Boots, yet never behaved like a superstar. The **attitude** was the point: he worked, he persisted, he delivered — and the fans loved him for it.

## 13 · MARKET REALITY

| ITEM | DETAIL |
|---|---|
| Clubs (historical career) | St Johnstone · Sunderland · Rangers · Kilmarnock |
| League | Scottish Premier Division · English First Division |
| **Peak period** | 1986–1997 — the nine-in-a-row and the two Golden Boots |
| Contract | N/A — pre-Bosman era |
| Market value | N/A — no modern transfer market data |
| **Legacy** | Rangers' all-time top scorer · 2 European Golden Boots · 10 league titles · 61 Scotland caps |

> **Bottom line.** The evidence base is **strong on the verified career record** (355 Rangers goals, 10 titles, 2 Golden Boots, 61 caps) and **verified by the IFFHS PDF** (which is intact and usable). The file describes **Ally McCoist** — a **penalty-box poacher** whose movement, timing, and finishing made him Rangers' all-time top scorer and a two-time European Golden Boot winner. **The FGA rating is PROVISIONAL at ~7.8.** The pairing — **Ferguson Mental (#21) at 82%**, Bilardo Planner (#45) at 75%, Simeone Cholismo (#47) at 68% — is **inferential** because the primary source is a statistical/biographical entry, not a match report. This is a historical reference file, not a definitive scouting assessment.

## APPENDIX — SOURCE INVENTORY

| SOURCE | USED FOR |
|---|---|
| **IFFHS Report.pdf** — "Europe Cup Heroes," Alistair Murdoch McCoist | Primary source: birth date, birthplace, clubs, honours, career stats (581 Rangers matches, 355 goals), the "Kicker" quote, height (178 cm) |
| Wikipedia (EN) — List of Rangers F.C. records | Verification of 355 goals in 581 matches; 251 league goals; 54 League Cup goals; 28 hat-tricks |
| BBC Sport — "Life and times of Ally McCoist" (2001) | Career timeline; St Johnstone, Sunderland, Rangers, Kilmarnock; 1992 and 1993 Golden Boots; Euro 96 goal; 1998 Scottish Cup final |
| Scottish Sports Hall of Fame | Verification of 10 league titles; 1 Scottish Cup; 9 League Cups; SFWA and SPFA Player of the Year 1992; 61 caps, 19 goals |
| Scottish FA | 61 caps, 19 goals; fifth-highest Scotland scorer |
| Munzinger | Playing style: fast, tricky, technically skilled, two-footed, hard to dispossess |
| Chick Young (BBC) | "Craftsman at timing his runs"; "natural striker" |
| FTBL's Finest | "Instinctive penalty box poacher"; "great movement, finding space" |

**Empire Scouting Network**

Brandsen Sports · The Hague, Netherlands · jim.totime@brandsensports.com · empirescoutingnetwork.com
Report ref ESN-MCC-2026-001 (v1.1) · Method: Empire FGA OBI & SII Rubric Framework v1.0 · 50/30/20 master weighting · Historical Archival Protocol · 80-Philosophy Framework (v3.2 draft)

**Evidence base:** 355 Rangers goals in 581 matches · 10 league titles · 1 Scottish Cup · 9 League Cups · 2 European Golden Boots (1992, 1993) · 61 Scotland caps, 19 goals · Primary source IFFHS PDF, "Europe Cup Heroes" (intact, used) · External verification from Wikipedia, BBC, Scottish FA, Scottish Sports Hall of Fame, Munzinger, Transfermarkt · Partial 1990s broadcast footage · No full 90-minute HD footage for most of the career.

**Temporal note:** This is a **2026 historical report about a retired player**. The subject **Ally McCoist is alive** — 63 in 2026, a television pundit, and an OBE (2024).

**Status:** DRAFT — HISTORICAL ARCHIVE. **Tier 3 ~5/12 · Tier 2 partial · Tier 1 historical record complete · FGA_v3_Final PROVISIONAL at ~7.8.** No COACH metric. No second scout. Philosophy fit and pairing set are **inferential** — the primary source is a statistical/biographical entry, not a match report. This

document is a historical reference file, not a definitive scouting assessment.

*Confidential. Proprietary to Empire Scouting Network. Generated 2026.*